

CALIO — Marketing & Distribution Strategy

Product: CALIO (Chrome extension) — SEC EDGAR companion: form-aware extract, compare, Excel/PDF export, local watchlist
Goal: Maximum **qualified installs** from people who actually open EDGAR (not vanity traffic)
Support: caliointel@gmail.com
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1. Positioning (use everywhere)

One-liner

Free Chrome extension to extract SEC EDGAR filings (10-K, 10-Q, 8-K, Form 4, ownership) and export to Excel — processing stays on your device.

Value props (pick 1–2 per post)

Pain	Message
EDGAR is clunky	Company desk + timeline next to public filings
Excel hard to get	Multi-sheet export without retyping tables
Form 4 messy	Form-aware insider extract (not random financials)
BamSEC expensive	Lightweight free companion for extracts (not a full suite clone)
Privacy	On-device; no filing storage on CALIO servers

Who to target first (highest fit)

1. **Retail value investors** who dig into filings (Reddit-heavy)
2. **Students / CFA candidates** learning 10-K / Form 4
3. **Indie / boutique researchers** without Bloomberg
4. **Side-project / Chrome extension** audiences (launch velocity)

Not primary day-1: large buy-side with AlphaSense/Bloomberg (harder, longer sales).

What NOT to say

- “Best free BamSEC” as a headline spam
- “Guaranteed alpha / beat the market”
- Investment advice claims

- Keyword-stuffed titles on Reddit/HN

2. Channel priority (max reach with limited time)

Priority	Channel	Why	Effort	Expected impact
P0	Chrome Web Store SEO + listing quality	Continuous organic installs	Low after launch	Steady long-term
P0	Reddit (value-first posts)	Your ICP already complains about EDGAR/Excel	Medium	Highest early installs if done right
P0	Product Hunt	Spike + backlink + directory SEO	Medium (1 day)	Burst of installs + links
P1	Hacker News (Show HN)	Tech + builder audience; some finance devs	Low	High variance, big upside
P1	Indie Hackers	Builders share tools; softer than Reddit finance	Low	Moderate + feedback
P1	LinkedIn (personal profile)	Equity research / finance students / ops	Ongoing	Credibility + B2B later
P2	X / FinTwit	Fast awareness; noisy	Ongoing	Moderate if useful threads
P2	Directories (AlternativeTo, etc.)	Long-tail Google	Low batch	SEO compound
P3	Discord / StockTwits	Secondary; promotion-sensitive	Selective	Small
P3	Paid ads	Only after conversion proven	Later	Optional

Rule: 90% value / community, 10% product mention (especially Reddit).

3. Reddit — communities ranked for CALIO

Tier A — highest relevance (post carefully)

Subreddit	Focus	How to post	Risk
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r/ValueInvesting	Fundamental / filing readers	Value-first: “How I export EDGAR to Excel” or free tool share; read rules (self-promo limited)	Medium–high if pure spam
r/SecurityAnalysis	Serious equity research	Strict anti-spam. Prefer helpful comments; soft tool mention only if asked	High ban risk for promo
r/stocks	Broad stock audience	Answer “how do you track 8-K / Excel from SEC?” threads; occasional tool post if high effort	Medium
r/investing	Long-term investing	Same: education posts, not ads	Medium
r/StockMarket	Market discussion	Form 4 / 8-K education angles	Medium

Tier B — strong secondary

Subreddit	Why it fits	Approach
r/options	Event / filing catalysts	8-K / Form 4 context posts (not day-trade spam)
r/Daytrading	Some care about filings	Only if post is about process , not signals
r/algotrading	EDGAR parsers / data	Technical post: extract packs, Excel pipeline
r/quantfinance	Quant / data	Same technical angle
r/quant	Pros + students	Careful; avoid “AI hype” tone
r/FinancialCareers	Analysts / students	“Tool that helped me practice 10-K extracts”
r/CFA	Exam / skills	Excel + filings study workflow
r/Accounting	Statements literacy	10-K extract → spreadsheet for learning

Tier C — product / builder (good for launch week)

Subreddit	Approach
r/chrome_extensions	“I shipped an EDGAR extract extension” — show tech + demo

r/SideProject	Build story + link
r/indiehackers	Launch + metrics
r/Entrepreneur	Only if framed as founder journey; often noisy
r/SaaS	Feedback on positioning / freemium later
r/AlphaandBetas	Tools for investors (check current rules)
r/SecurityAnalysis tools discussions	Comment-first only

Tier D — use only as comments, not cold promo

Subreddit	Why caution
r/wallstreetbets	Wrong culture; tools posts die or get mocked
r/pennystocks	Spam association risk
r/Robinhood	App-centric; weak EDGAR ICP

Reddit playbook (to not get banned)

1. **Warm the account:** 2–3 weeks of genuine comments before any product link.
2. **90/10 rule:** ≤10% of your posts are self-promo.
3. **Read each sub's rules** the day you post (they change).
4. **Best post formats:**
 - “How to get SEC financials into Excel in 2026 (EDGAR path + free extension)”
 - “I got tired of Form 4 HTML — built a form-aware extract for Chrome”
 - Reply in existing threads: “Accessing Excel from SEC”, “BamSEC alternative”, “keep up with 8-Ks”
5. **Bad formats:** “Check out my startup”, multi-sub spam same day, affiliate tone.
6. **Timing:** US morning weekdays (9–11am ET) for finance; evenings for SideProject.
7. **Assets:** 1 GIF/video of extract → Excel beats walls of text.

Sample Reddit post skeleton (ValueInvesting / stocks)

Title: How I pull SEC filings into Excel without retyping EDGAR tables
Body: - Pain: Interactive Data Excel path is buried / Form 4s are painful - Manual option: Financial_Report.xlsx in archive folder (brief) - What I built: free Chrome extension, on-device extract, form-aware packs - What it is NOT: not investment advice, not a BamSEC replacement for full research suites - Link: Chrome Web Store - Ask: what form types do you extract most? happy to improve packs

4. LinkedIn strategy

Who to connect / post to

Persona	Keywords for search
Equity research analyst	"Equity Research", "Research Associate"
Investment analyst / associate	"Investment Analyst", "IB Analyst" (students/alumni)
Portfolio manager (boutique)	"Portfolio Manager" + "value" / "long only"
Finance students / CFA	"CFA Candidate", "MBA Finance"
Compliance / ops (secondary)	"Investment Ops", "Research Ops"
Founders of finance tools	Peer distribution

Content pillars (2–3 posts/week)

1. **Educational:** "5 Form 4 codes that actually matter (P vs A vs M)"
2. **Workflow:** "Company desk → extract → Excel in under 2 minutes" (screen recording)
3. **Build in public:** "Shipped CALIO v1 — free EDGAR companion for Chrome"
4. **Opinion:** "Why raw EDGAR still wins if you can structure it"

Tactics that work on LinkedIn

- Post from **personal profile** (not a dead company page first).
- First comment under your post = Chrome Web Store link (algorithm often prefers less link-in-body).
- Tag neutrally (don't spam people).
- Engage 15 min after posting (reply to every comment).
- Use **document carousels** (PDF: "EDGAR → Excel checklist").
- Join/participate in conversations under hashtags:

#EquityResearch #ValueInvesting #SEC #EDGAR #FinancialModeling #CFA #FinTech

LinkedIn groups (join, then contribute — don't dump links day 1)

Search and join groups such as:

- Equity Research / Investment Analysis groups
- CFA charterholder / candidate groups
- Value Investing communities
- FinTech founders / product groups
- Chrome / productivity for professionals

Rule: answer questions for 1–2 weeks; then share CALIO as a free resource once.

Outreach (soft)

- Connection note: no pitch.
- After connect: “Built a free EDGAR extract tool for Chrome — happy to share if useful for filing work.”
- Target **commenters** on popular equity-research posts (they’re active).

5. Product Hunt launch

Item	Recommendation
When	Tue–Thu often competitive; some founders prefer quieter days — test; avoid major tech news days
Hunter	Optional experienced hunter helps; self-hunt is fine if prepared
Assets	Gallery: 5 store screenshots + 30–60s silent demo (extract → Excel)
Tagline	“Extract SEC EDGAR filings to Excel — on-device Chrome companion”
First comment	Story + link + “what should we build next”
Day-of	Be online 12+ hours; reply to every comment
Audience	Notify friends to upvote only if they try (fake engagement hurts)
After	Use PH backlink for SEO; don’t expect lasting traffic alone

6. Hacker News

Item	Do
Format	Show HN: CALIO – Chrome extension to extract SEC EDGAR filings to Excel
Tone	Dry, technical, honest limits
Body	What it does, stack (MV3), privacy (local), what it doesn’t do
Avoid	Marketing words, “disrupt”, “revolutionary”
Engage	Answer technical questions for hours

7. Indie Hackers

- Post in **Milestones** / product launch: free extension, install goal, lessons.
- Offer free use; ask for feedback on Form 4 / Excel packs.
- Cross-link PH / CWS.

8. X (Twitter) / FinTwit

Tactic	Detail
Handle	Clear name + “SEC EDGAR / filings” in bio + CWS link
Content	Thread: “Form 4 in 60 seconds with CALIO” + video
Hashtags (light)	#ValueInvesting #SEC #EDGAR #stocks (don’t spam 10 tags)
Engage	Reply under BamSEC / EDGAR / 10-K tips accounts with value, not “check my tool”
Lists	Follow equity research + value investor lists

9. Directories & listing sites (batch in one afternoon)

Submit once; consistent name/description:

Site	Why
AlternativeTo	List as alternative to BamSEC / EDGAR tools — strong SEO
SaaSHub	Product discovery
BetaList	If still early
Uneed / similar indie directories	Launch lists
There's An AI For That	Only if you honestly market AI features (skip if not)
Chrome Web Store category browsing	Listing quality already covered
G2 / Capterra	Later if you productize SaaS

10. Communities beyond Reddit/LinkedIn

Platform	Fit	How
Discord	Value investing / stock research servers	Ask mods before promo; share in #tools if allowed
StockTwits	Traders	Weak for deep EDGAR; light awareness only
Facebook groups	Value investing groups	Same 90/10 rule
University finance clubs	High intent students	Free workshop: "EDGAR to Excel"
Substack notes / comments	Finance writers	Offer tool in relevant comment threads
YouTube	Long-form	"How to export SEC filings to Excel 2026" SEO video → CWS link

11. 30-day launch calendar

Week 1 — Foundation

- ☐ Chrome Web Store live / approved
- ☐ CWS link final; support email caliointel@gmail.com
- ☐ 5 screenshots + 30s demo GIF
- ☐ Warm Reddit account (10+ helpful comments, no links)
- ☐ LinkedIn profile: headline includes "built CALIO – free SEC EDGAR Chrome tool"

Week 2 — Soft launch

- ☐ r/chrome_extensions + r/SideProject (build story)
- ☐ Indie Hackers launch post
- ☐ LinkedIn "I shipped" post + demo
- ☐ Submit AlternativeTo + 3–5 directories
- ☐ Answer 5 existing Reddit threads about EDGAR/Excel

Week 3 — Finance audiences

- ☐ High-effort post: r/ValueInvesting or r/stocks (education-first)
- ☐ r/CFA or r/FinancialCareers (study/workflow angle)
- ☐ X thread with demo
- ☐ Product Hunt: prepare assets + schedule

Week 4 — Spike + learn

- [] Product Hunt launch day (full presence)
- [] Show HN same week or following (not same hour as PH)
- [] Collect feedback → ship 1–2 fixes → post changelog
- [] Ask 10 users for honest CWS reviews (after they use export)

12. Metrics that matter

Metric	Target (first 30–60 days, realistic)
CWS installs	100–500 if distribution is solid
Weekly active users / installs	Keep high (retention = ranking)
CWS rating	≥ 4.3 with real reviews
Top referral sources	Track UTM on store links if possible
Qualitative	"I used this for Form 4 / 10-Q" messages

Ignore: empty LinkedIn likes, WSB dunks, vanity follower counts.

13. UTM / link hygiene

Use one short link or UTM per channel, e.g.:

```
?utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=valueinvesting
?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=launch
?utm_source=producthunt&utm_medium=referral&utm_campaign=launch
?utm_source=hn&utm_medium=referral&utm_campaign=showhn
```

Chrome Web Store may strip some params; still use for your own site later.

14. Message bank (copy-paste)

LinkedIn post

- I built a free Chrome extension for people who actually open SEC EDGAR.
- CALIO: company desk, form-aware extract (10-K/Q, 8-K, Form 4, ownership), compare periods, multi-sheet Excel — processing on your device.
- Not investment advice. Not a full research terminal. Just less pain between filings and your spreadsheet.

Link in comments — feedback welcome, especially on Form 4 packs.

Show HN title

Show HN: CALIO – extract SEC EDGAR filings to Excel in Chrome (local)

PH tagline

Extract SEC EDGAR filings to Excel — free, on-device Chrome companion

15. Risk & compliance (marketing)

- Always: **not investment advice**; public EDGAR only.
- Don't imply affiliation with SEC or BamSEC.
- Don't buy reviews/installs.
- Respect each community's promo rules — one ban can wipe a channel.

16. Recommended weekly routine (after launch)

Day	Action
Mon	LinkedIn educational post
Tue	Reddit comments in 2 finance subs
Wed	Engage PH/HN leftovers or ship small fix
Thu	Directory / outreach (5 blogs or “tools for investors” pages)
Fri	X thread or demo clip
Weekend	Measure installs; plan next feature from feedback

17. Quick reference — top 10 places to show up

1. Chrome Web Store (always on)
2. r/ValueInvesting
3. r/stocks / r/investing (thread replies + rare posts)
4. r/chrome_extensions
5. Product Hunt
6. Hacker News Show HN

7. Indie Hackers
 8. LinkedIn personal + finance hashtags
 9. AlternativeTo (BamSEC / EDGAR alternatives)
 10. r/CFA + r/FinancialCareers (students/analysts)
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18. Next actions for you (this week)

1. Confirm CWS is **Submitted / Published**.
 2. Create a **30–60s demo** (screen record extract → Excel).
 3. Write **one** high-effort Reddit education post (don't blast 10 subs same day).
 4. Post **one** LinkedIn ship post.
 5. Submit **AlternativeTo** + schedule **Product Hunt**.
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This file lives in: Desktop/compliance tools/CALIO_Marketing_Strategy.md

Product repo: Desktop/CALIO_MVP/